

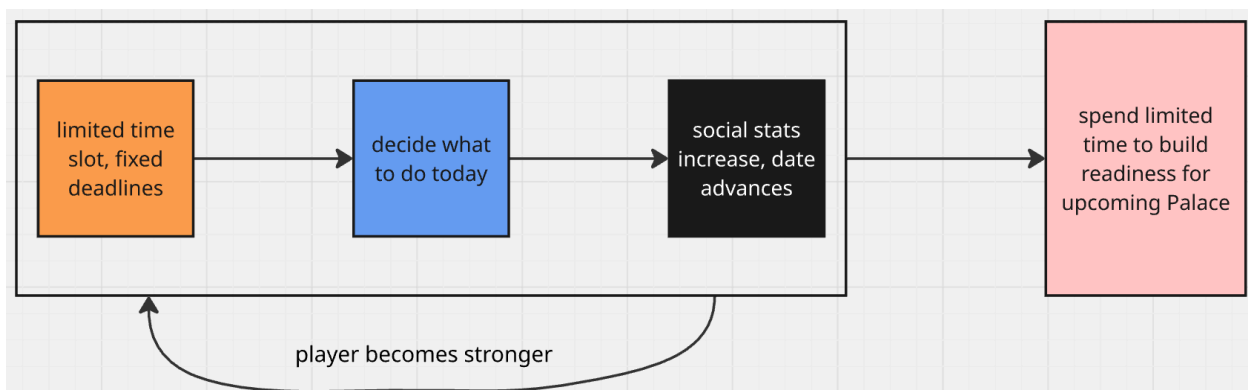
Persona 5 Royal Game Loops Analysis

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Persona 5 is a turn-based JRPG where you live a student's daily life and fight supernatural battles occasionally. The game is built around a calendar: each day you choose how to spend limited time (spend time with friends, grow your skills, do part-time jobs), while also entering "Palaces" (dungeons) to defeat enemies and complete story deadlines.

Loop 1: Daily time & decision loop



Time scale: Seconds-to-minutes.

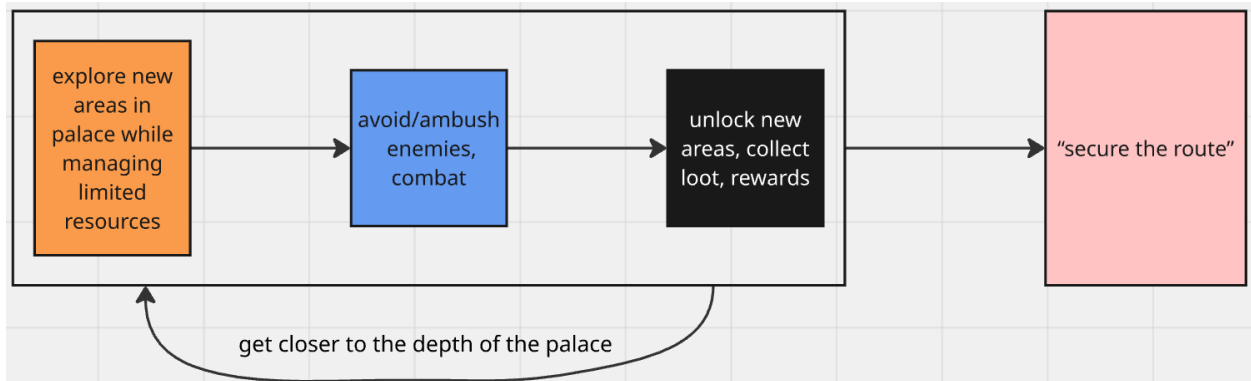
Clarity: Very clear. The game tells you the date, upcoming deadlines, and offers obvious actions (go somewhere, study, hang out, work).

Motivation: Each day has only so many time slots, so the player is very motivated to start a new day. You want to “use the day well” and meet story deadlines.

Feedback: Immediate (stat bars go up, new locations unlock, messages from friends).

Satisfaction: Not much satisfaction due to needing enough small daily wins to stack up into visible progress.

Loop 2: Palace infiltration loop



Time scale: Hours.

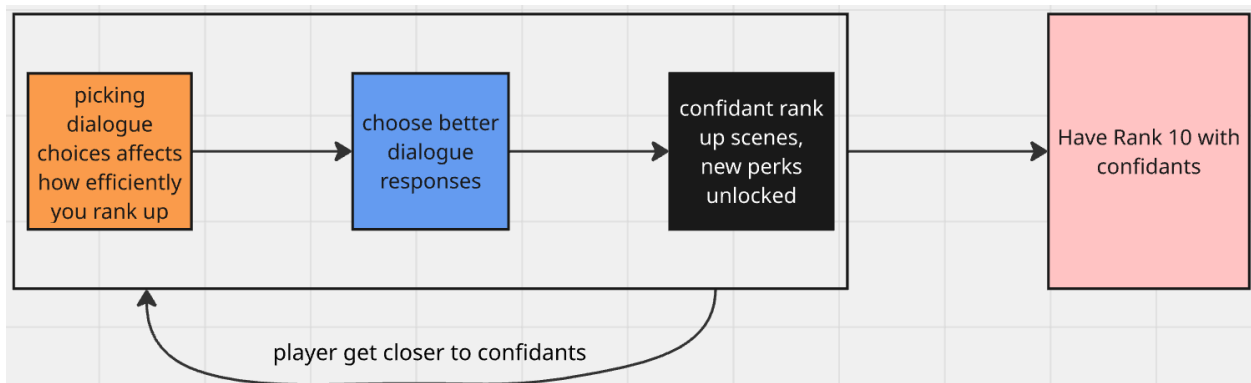
Clarity: Mostly clear: enter dungeon → explore → fight → reach boss.

Motivation: Gain rewards (money, new Personas, items) and be stronger after each fight.

Feedback: Strong, constant feedback: loot drops, level-ups, new skills.

Satisfaction: Winning fights and gaining rewards creates great satisfaction.

Loop 3: Confidants stats loop



Time scale: Minutes per scene.

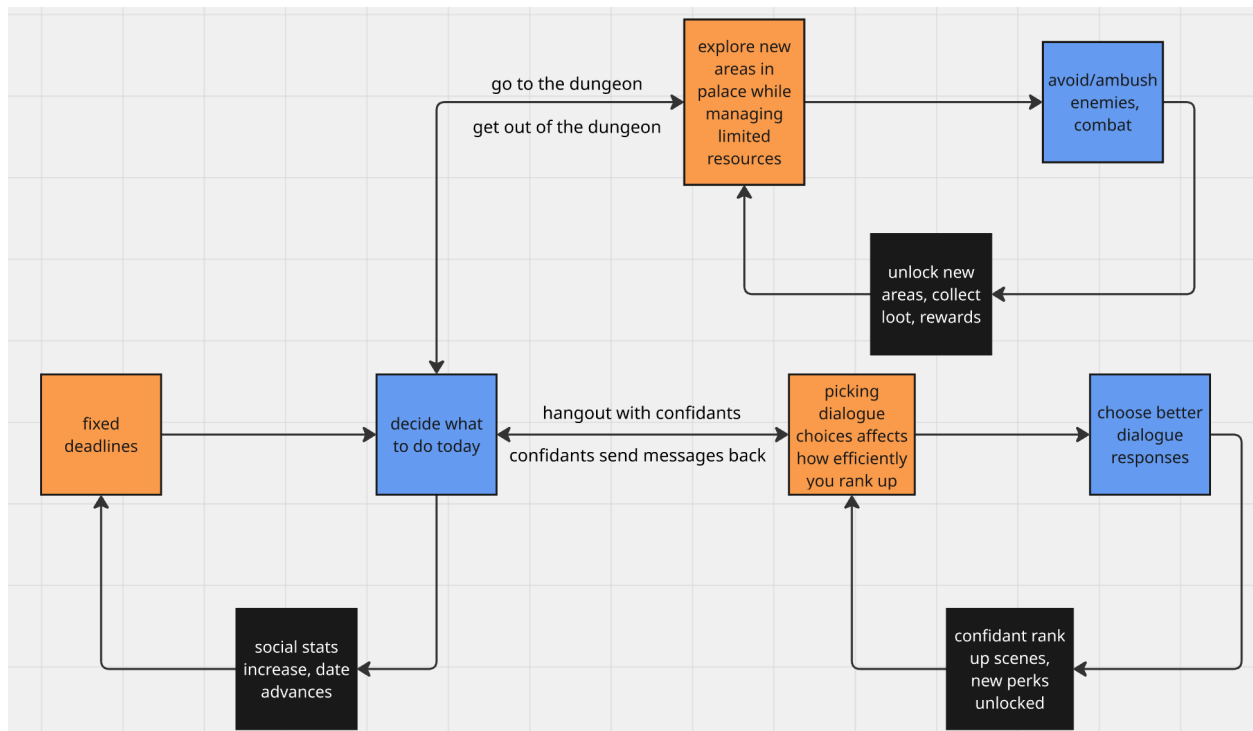
Clarity: Clear: spend time with a character → choose the response that can score more points with them → gain relationship rank → unlock new dialogue.

Motivation: Very motivated if the player wants to watch new stories with characters, or want better combat perks.

Feedback: Immediate (new abilities unlocked and visible stat increases).

Satisfaction: Feels good because characters react closer to you as you spend more time with them.

Summary



The overall goal is to complete each story arc by changing a major target's "heart" (finish the dungeon objective) before the deadline, while growing strong enough (in combat power and social support) to succeed.

The loops feed into each other by the following:

- Daily time loop decides whether you spend today on dungeon progress, preparation, or social growth.
- The game feedback gained in confidants stats loop improves dungeon success. Relationship perks often make combat, money, negotiating, and time efficiency better.

- Dungeon rewards (the game feedback gained in palace infiltration loop) feed back into daily life. Money/items/new Personas enable better preparation (buy items that can improve favorability, buy new gear, fusion...)

There's time scarcity and pressure on spending too many days on social stats and risk missing the dungeon deadline, but I would say there's not really tensions or trade-offs. Pushing deeper into a dungeon is fun, but running out of HP/items can force a retreat and "waste" a day, so players are encouraged to prepare well (by growing the party strength and building relationship perks) before going to the dungeon.